NFL Week 5: Engine vs. Framework

Sunday, October 11, 2026, plus Monday night. All times Phoenix. Logged before kickoff (4:50 AM Sunday). No betting lines go into either one.

Kickoff	Game	Engine (official)	Framework	Framework score	Conf.	
6:30 AM	Eagles vs Jaguars (London)	**Jaguars 74.5%**	**Jaguars 85.3%**	Jaguars 29-Eagles 16	9	Agree
10:00 AM	Bears at Packers	No pick: Caleb Williams questionable; Tyson Bagent starts				
10:00 AM	Bengals at Dolphins	**Bengals 74.2%**	Bengals 68.7%	Bengals 25-Dolphins 19	7	Agree
10:00 AM	Browns at Jets	Jets 56.3%	Jets 57.0%	Jets 23-Browns 20	6	Agree
10:00 AM	Colts at Steelers	Colts 58.5%	Steelers 60.1%	Steelers 23-Colts 20	6	**Split**
10:00 AM	Giants at Commanders	Commanders 55.9%	Commanders 62.7%	Commanders 23-Giants 19	6	Agree
10:00 AM	Raiders at Patriots	Patriots 69.8%	Raiders 64.1%	Raiders 24-Patriots 19	6	**Split**
10:00 AM	Texans at Titans	Texans 63.8%	Texans 53.4%	Texans 22-Titans 21	5	Agree
10:00 AM	Vikings at Saints	Vikings 58.6%	**Vikings 76.4%**	Vikings 27-Saints 18	8	Agree
1:05 PM	Broncos at Chargers	Chargers 55.6%	Broncos 54.7%	Broncos 23-Chargers 22	5	**Split**
1:25 PM	49ers at Seahawks	Seahawks 55.5%	49ers 57.0%	49ers 24-Seahawks 22	6	**Split**
1:25 PM	Lions at Cardinals	Cardinals 58.8%	Lions 55.6%	Lions 26-Cardinals 24	6	**Split**
5:20 PM	Ravens at Falcons	No pick: Lamar Jackson ruled out; Tyler Huntley starts				
Mon 5:15 PM	Bills at Rams	**Rams 74.5%**	Rams 52.7%	Rams 25-Bills 24	5	Agree

They agree on 7 of 12 picks (green) and split on 5 (amber). Bold = 70%+. Conf. is the framework's confidence, its win chance in tenths (7 = about 70%).

Parlay (framework, $25): Jaguars + Vikings + Bengals. All three hit about 45% of the time by the framework's numbers and about 32% by the engine's (it has the Vikings at 58.6%). Fair payout on $25 is about $56; a sportsbook pays less, so the ticket must pay at least $50 to reach the $25 profit target. The Jaguars leg kicks off at 6:30 AM.

How far to trust them. On the same 887 games (2022-2025), the engine picked 64.0% of winners, the framework 62.6% and the closing-line favorite 68.7%. When the two split, the engine was right 54% of the time. Both are weaker early in the season. The closing line has been more accurate than either, so a high win chance is not the same as a good bet.

QB status as of 4:50 AM Sunday: Jayden Daniels reported starting for Washington; Jameis Winston starts for the Giants (Jaxson Dart out for the season). Re-check inactives 90 minutes before each kickoff; if a starting QB changes, drop that pick.

Why the framework picked each team

Game	Framework	Engine	Why (framework)
Eagles vs Jaguars (London)	**Jaguars** 85.3%	Jaguars 74.5%	Ahead on 4 of 5 criteria: +0.31 net EPA per play vs -0.18; the Eagles' rush gets pressure on 8.6% of dropbacks (Jaguars 18.5%); Lawrence +0.29 EPA per dropback vs Hurts -0.06; 55% on third down, 86% red-zone TDs, +1.5 turnovers per game. Neutral site, equal rest.
Vikings at Saints	**Vikings** 76.4%	Vikings 58.6%	Vikings defense: -0.18 EPA per play allowed, 25.5% pressure, blitz on 73% of dropbacks against a Shough at -0.17 when blitzed. Saints D allows +0.14 per play, 48% on third down, 73% red-zone TDs; Saints -1.5 turnovers per game. Home field and Murray's -0.16 per dropback trim it.
Bengals at Dolphins	**Bengals** 68.7%	Bengals 74.2%	Net EPA +0.08 vs -0.27; Burrow (+0.12 per dropback) faces a pass defense allowing +0.31 while Willis is at -0.17. Trenches even; home field is Miami's only edge.
Raiders at Patriots	**Raiders** 64.1%	Patriots 69.8%	Ahead on 4 of 5: net EPA +0.11 vs -0.06, pressure 22.6% vs 15.8%, Cousins +0.17 per dropback vs Maye -0.01, turnovers +1.25 vs -1.25 per game. The engine likes New England because it uses last season and opponent strength; the framework uses neither.
Giants at Commanders	**Commanders** 62.7%	Commanders 55.9%	Giants' line allows pressure on 19.8% of dropbacks and their rush gets 9.8%; Winston is at -0.75 EPA when blitzed and Washington blitzes 47%. Net efficiency even. Daniels returns from a dislocated elbow; his +0.20 per dropback is from weeks 1-2 only (61 dropbacks).
Colts at Steelers	**Steelers** 60.1%	Colts 58.5%	Efficiency nearly even (-0.13 vs -0.11 net EPA), so 10 days' rest vs 7 (Colts back from London) and home field tip it. Engine leans Colts: treat as a coin flip.
49ers at Seahawks	**49ers** 57.0%	Seahawks 55.5%	Purdy +0.58 EPA per dropback (+1.16 when blitzed); San Francisco converts 59% on third down and 89% of red-zone trips vs Seattle's 31% and 65%. Seattle's defense wins the trenches; home field keeps it close.
Browns at Jets	**Jets** 57.0%	Jets 56.3%	Small edges add up: net EPA +0.04 vs -0.08, Smith +0.16 per dropback vs Watson +0.10, turnovers +0.5 vs 0 per game. Cleveland's rush and 10 days' rest offset part of home field.
Lions at Cardinals	**Lions** 55.6%	Cardinals 58.8%	Two leaky defenses; Goff +0.22 per dropback (+0.32 when blitzed) vs Brissett -0.03 (-0.39). Detroit's rush 18.7% pressure vs 13.8%. Home field takes most of it back; engine leans Arizona.
Broncos at Chargers	**Broncos** 54.7%	Chargers 55.6%	Denver's line allows pressure on 10.5% of dropbacks vs the Chargers' 21.4%; Chargers' offense -0.16 EPA per play, Herbert -0.15 per dropback. Engine leans Chargers: coin flip.
Texans at Titans	**Texans** 53.4%	Texans 63.8%	Slightly better efficiency (-0.07 vs -0.16 net EPA) and QB (Stroud +0.09 per dropback vs Ward -0.11); home field gives most of it back. Engine is more confident (64%).
Bills at Rams	**Rams** 52.7%	Rams 74.5%	Buffalo has the better offense (+0.20 EPA per play, Allen +0.29 per dropback) but allows +0.10 per play; the Rams lead net efficiency (+0.16 vs +0.10). Home field makes it a coin flip leaning Rams; engine much more confident.

Engine: the locked college method with the approved NFL settings. It rates every offense and defense on EPA and success rate, adjusted for opponents, starting from 30% of last season, with recent games counting more. **Framework:** your Prompt Football criteria (trenches 25%, net efficiency 25%, passing 20%, situational 15%, high leverage 15%) scored from this season's play-by-play only. EPA = expected points added per play; pressure = sacks plus QB hits per dropback; blitz = 5+ pass rushers. Files: results/nfl_cfbmethod_2026_week05_picks.csv, results/prompt_nfl_2026_week05_picks.csv.